

Elaine has made it a priority to be responsible for what she is putting into the world. “There’s a lot of garbage out there,” she says. So she makes her magnets out of 70 percent recycled material, and she’s recently moved her boxes from 100 percent plastic to 90 percent paper packaging. Don’t worry: this hasn’t affected profit margins. In fact, it’s only garnered the company *more* buzz, landing Easy Daysies a spot on Dr. Toy’s Top 10 Socially Responsible Toys of 2012. More buzz translates into more profits, which is good for all of us.

Money Mistake: *You Think a Business Is About Products, Not People*
The Fix: *Don’t Neglect Your Relationships*

Elaine Comeau is someone who deeply values her relationships. She’s a generous mother and a loving wife, and she brings the same warmth and personal attention to all her business relationships. “I bake for every meeting I go to,” she says. “I am trying to build a lasting relationship, not just close a sale. The first retail store in B.C. that sold Easy Daysies still jokes that I am the only supplier who has ever come in with product *and* a fresh-baked batch of chocolate chip cookies!”

While you’ll never see me bring fresh-baked cookies to a business meeting, it’s a good approach for Elaine. In the industry she’s in, it works. But *every* business is based on trust. Any time you can extend a bond and personalize a relationship with a client or supplier, you are adding a tremendous amount of equity in perpetuity. People will want to buy your product or service, simply because they trust you.

Elaine has witnessed the value of adding equity to Easy Daysies through building relationships with her clients. “Something that keeps me going is that I am constantly getting emails from people,” she says. “Pregnant moms, mothers of children with autism, parents of foster children. They’re all so grateful to have a clear, easy way to organize the day. Easy Daysies has helped these kids stick to their routines and get their homework done on time. And it’s not just for